

Taneira, which is also not making much money,” she says.

C. K. Venkataraman, Titan’s Managing Director, says Taneira is ready for showtime. “Twenty years ago, in 2004, Tanishq was also a small brand. In five years, Taneira will become a major brand. We have already set a target of ₹1,000 crore in the next two years,” he says.

Kunal Vora, head of India equity research at BNP Paribas, says jewellery will always have an edge. “It’s not that the other business segments like Taneira or watches & wearables haven’t grown. But due to the nature of their business, jewellery will always hold the largest share,” says Vora.

in which demand hit 40 million units in 2024. Premium players such as Apple boosted aspiration levels, and mass-market brands such as Boulton, Noise, and boAt fed demand. Titan entered the market in 2021 and, by March 2024, had 6.7% of the volume, per IDC.

In the March quarter, while the Top 3 players registered negative growth, Titan grew 92% year-on-year, led by Fastrack, a young, mass-market, mid-segment brand. In FY24, Titan added 44 Fastrack stores and renovated 33.

Second, Titan premiumised its portfolio as consumers avoided mass-market discretionary products, pushing three brands—Nebula, Edge and Xylem. Nebula

in the April-June FY25 quarter, it reported 15% year-over-year growth. “Due to the sheer scale of the jewellery business, it is natural that its share has increased. But what is more important for us is gaining consumer market share in each category we are present.... We need to be the leader in the markets,” says Venkataraman.

Gold’s steady rise hurt Titan’s growth in Q1FY25. Sales of its jewellery division were up just 9%, as gold prices went up by double digits and illegal imports increased.

Respite, however, came from an unlikely quarter. When Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman announced in her July 23 Budget speech a cut in the effective im-



“We will be among the top three national jewellery retailers over the next five years and will continue to grow at a CAGR of 50%”

KUMAR MANGALAM BIRLA, CHAIRMAN, ADITYA BIRLA GROUP, AT THE LAUNCH OF INDRIYA IN NEW DELHI

INDIA’S NEW TIMEKEEPER?

Titan is one of the largest players in the local wristwatch market, with some 1,135 stores. Sales of the watches and wearables division increased to nearly ₹4,000 crore in FY24 from zero in mid-2020 and ₹2,600 crore in FY20.

Suparna Mitra, the division’s chief executive, says business has steadily grown after the economy put behind the Covid-19 lockdowns. Sales grew at 31% CAGR between FY22 and FY24, against 3% between FY15 and FY20.

First, Titan entered the fast-growing smartwatch market,

watches, made of precious metals, are for affluent women in the aspirational luxury segment. Edge is a unisex brand, while Xylus is positioned as a Swiss-made watch.

CHALLENGES IN THE MASS MARKET

Titan’s mass-market Sonata and Fastrack slowed down in 2024. Titan’s annual report states, “Affordable analogue watch brands like Sonata and Fastrack saw major headwinds as consumers held on to purchasing.”

However, Titan’s costlier watches gained traction, and

port duty rate on gold from 18.5% to 9.2%, gold became cheaper, making life easier for everybody.

Chauhan of Sky Gold said this has brought back consumers. “The duty cut will reduce illegal imports, boosting the fortunes of large branded players who use only legal gold,” he said.

Venkataraman is betting on women to power the Titan range, not just jewellery. “The aim is to position the brands as such that a lady starts the day with a Skinn perfume and ends it with a Tanishq necklace,” he says. **BT**

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